

# What these failures share

*Three failure modes · one root cause*

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## FAILURE 1

### The recall ceiling

*retriever decides once →  
reranker can't see what was dropped*

## FAILURE 2

### The drift problem

*reformulations decided once →  
drift accumulates with each one*

## FAILURE 3

### The cost wall

*budget allocated once →  
reasoning rerankers priced out*